



Where Mark stands.

Nine issues that matter at Oregon kitchen tables — and one candidate's plain answers on every single one. No outrage. No spin. Just where he stands and why.

Mark Norman

OREGON HOUSE DISTRICT 27 • REPUBLICAN • 2026

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[BEFORE YOU READ]

You deserve straight answers. Here they are.

I'm not a career politician. I spent 22 years in the U.S. Navy, nearly 30 years as a veterinarian, and 25 years living and working right here in Washington County. This guide exists because I believe you're busy, smart, and skeptical — and you shouldn't have to dig through slogans to find out where a candidate actually stands.

Inside are the nine issues people ask me about most, in my own words. You may not agree with everything — that's fine. Most Oregonians are exhausted by constant outrage and ideological purity tests. What you'll get from me is the same thing every time: a plain answer, the reasoning behind it, and respect for your right to disagree.

Mark Norman

NAVY VETERAN • VETERINARIAN • SMALL-BUSINESS OWNER

01 Public Safety

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[ISSUE 01 / PUBLIC SAFETY]

Public safety is the first job of government.

Families should feel safe in their homes, children walking to school, seniors on public transportation, and businesses investing in their communities. Too many Oregonians no longer feel that basic sense of security.

Oregon has seen rising frustration over crime, drug activity, repeat offenders, property crime, and slow emergency response — while law enforcement agencies struggle with staffing shortages, low morale, and recruiting. Oregon already ranks near the bottom nationally in officers per capita. I support **fully funding public safety** so agencies have the personnel, training, technology, and resources to protect communities effectively and professionally.

We must also address the policy failures behind public disorder: untreated addiction, mental illness, chronic homelessness, and weak prosecution of repeat offenders. Supporting law enforcement and supporting accountability are not mutually exclusive — most officers serve honorably under increasingly difficult conditions, and they deserve leadership that supports both effective policing and public trust.

MARK SUPPORTS

- ☐ Improved recruitment, retention & competitive pay
- ☐ Behavioral health & crisis response partnerships
- ☐ Stronger community policing
- ☐ Better coordination between local agencies
- ☐ De-escalation & constitutional policing training
- ☐ Real treatment access & accountability

“Oregonians should not have to choose between compassion and safety. We must have both.”

[ISSUE 02 / EDUCATION]

Oregon's children deserve far better.

Despite spending billions of taxpayer dollars on education, Oregon ranks near the bottom nationally in reading and math. That should concern every parent, taxpayer, and employer — regardless of party.

This is **not a criticism of our teachers**. Oregon has many dedicated educators who care deeply about their students. The problem is that state education leadership lost focus on academic fundamentals. While other states aggressively implemented evidence-based reading and math reforms, Oregon moved slowly and too often prioritized bureaucracy and ideology over measurable academic success.

Families see the results: declining reading proficiency, poor math performance, classroom disruption, chronic absenteeism, and graduates without the skills they need for college, trades, military service, or work. Schools should focus first on reading, writing, mathematics, science, civics, discipline, and critical thinking — and local districts need flexibility to serve their own students rather than one-size-fits-all mandates from Salem.

MARK SUPPORTS

- ☐ Reading instruction grounded in the science of reading
- ☐ Strong math fundamentals
- ☐ Clear academic standards & classroom accountability
- ☐ Parent transparency & partnership
- ☐ Safe, orderly learning environments
- ☐ Local flexibility over Salem mandates

“Our teachers should be empowered to teach. Parents should be respected as partners. And students should leave school truly prepared for adult life.”

[ISSUE 03 / SMALL BUSINESS]

Small businesses are Oregon's backbone.

Family-owned businesses, contractors, restaurants, farms, retailers, and startups are struggling under growing layers of taxes, regulations, permit delays, and rising costs coming out of Salem.

Rising payroll taxes, the Corporate Activity Tax, escalating insurance costs, energy prices driven by the Climate Protection Program, and permitting delays have many entrepreneurs questioning whether they can survive in Oregon. Small businesses cannot simply absorb endless new costs — those costs become higher prices, reduced hiring, lower wages, or closures. Meanwhile, large corporations have the attorneys and influence to navigate these systems far more easily than small local employers. **That is backwards.**

One of my first legislative priorities will be policies specifically focused on small-business growth, regulatory reform, and economic opportunity. Oregon's economy will not be strengthened by expanding bureaucracy — it will be strengthened by rewarding hard work and restoring an environment where small businesses can succeed.

MARK SUPPORTS

- ☐ Cutting duplicative regulations & permitting
- ☐ Streamlined licensing & approvals
- ☐ Limits on excessive fee increases
- ☐ Access to startup capital & workforce training
- ☐ Protecting independent contractors from heavy mandates
- ☐ Targeted small-business tax relief

“We should be making it easier — not harder — for hardworking Oregonians to start businesses, create jobs, and build successful futures.”

[ISSUE 04 / TRANSPORTATION & ENERGY]

Policies grounded in reality, not ideology.

The transportation landscape changed permanently after 2020. Remote and hybrid work reduced commuter traffic, and TriMet ridership remains roughly one-third below its peak — yet Salem keeps pushing multi-billion-dollar rail projects built on outdated assumptions.

I support public transportation — but it must serve **actual rider behavior**, not planning models. Buses already carry more riders in many corridors because they are flexible, less expensive, and faster to deploy. Before committing taxpayers to more rail, we must honestly evaluate ridership trends, operating deficits, public safety, and financial sustainability.

The same honesty applies to energy. The Climate Protection Program is raising utility, fuel, food, and housing costs for Oregon families — while having virtually no measurable impact on global climate outcomes. Environmental stewardship matters, but good policy balances it with affordability, reliability, and scientific honesty.

MARK SUPPORTS

- ☐ Transit investment driven by real ridership
- ☐ Affordability & mobility as first measures
- ☐ All-of-the-above energy: hydro, natural gas, renewables
- ☐ Next-generation nuclear, including SMRs
- ☐ Honest review before new rail spending
- ☐ Relief from cost-raising climate surcharges

“We should invest in infrastructure people actually use, energy systems that reliably work, and policies that strengthen Oregon families.”

[ISSUE 05 / DATA CENTERS]

Growth, yes — but responsible growth.

Data centers are becoming one of the defining infrastructure and economic issues facing Washington County and Oregon. I support responsible development — and clear standards that protect the communities around it.

Technology, AI, and digital infrastructure are critical to the modern economy and can strengthen Oregon's long-term competitiveness. But residents are right to be concerned about electricity demand, water consumption, land use, utility costs, and tax fairness. **Oregon families should not bear higher costs so multinational corporations can receive unlimited subsidies without accountability.** I do not support reckless expansion that strains our grid or threatens groundwater.

If Oregon wants advanced manufacturing, semiconductors, and AI infrastructure, we must be honest about the energy required. That is why I strongly support expanding modern nuclear energy — especially Small Modular Reactor (SMR) technology — alongside hydro, natural gas, and renewables. Smart regulation beats blanket moratoriums that drive investment and jobs out of Oregon.

MARK'S STANDARDS FOR NEW DEVELOPMENT

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Adequate power generation | ☐ Real infrastructure investment |
| ☐ Water sustainability | ☐ Fair tax contribution |
| ☐ Environmental stewardship | ☐ Protection for local ratepayers |

“We need balanced leadership that understands both economic growth and resource stewardship — not reactionary policies.”

[ISSUE 06 / HEALTH CARE]

Practical reform, not a government takeover.

As a medical professional who has spent nearly 30 years caring for patients and families, I understand the frustration: costs are too high, insurance bureaucracy is overwhelming, and too many families delay care over affordability.

But Oregon families deserve solutions grounded in reality — not ideological promises that risk making healthcare more expensive and less accessible. **I do not support a government-run single-payer healthcare system for Oregon.** A state-run system would almost certainly require massive new taxes on working families, employers, and providers, while creating more bureaucracy, workforce shortages, and longer waits — and risks driving physicians and specialists out of Oregon when access is already strained.

Healthcare reform should increase affordability, access, transparency, and patient choice. Healthcare decisions should remain between patients and their healthcare professionals — not centralized through expanding layers of government control.

MARK'S PRIORITIES

- ☐ More access to primary & preventive care
- ☐ Less administrative burden on providers
- ☐ Real price transparency
- ☐ Competition, innovation & independent practices
- ☐ Stronger rural & community healthcare access
- ☐ Practical mental health & addiction treatment

“Compassion must be paired with competence, sustainability, accountability, and honesty about costs and consequences.”

[ISSUE 07 / VETERAN SUPPORT]

The commitment runs both ways.

As a retired Navy veteran, I understand that military service leaves a lasting impact long after the uniform is removed. Our veterans fulfilled their commitment to this nation — government and society should fulfill their commitment to them.

Military service builds discipline, leadership, resilience, and purpose. But too many veterans still struggle with the transition to civilian life: homelessness, unemployment or underemployment, barriers to medical care, mental health challenges, substance abuse, social isolation, and increasingly complex government systems.

Oregon should strengthen partnerships between veterans organizations, healthcare providers, employers, local communities, and state agencies — so veterans never fall through bureaucratic cracks while trying to obtain services **they earned through their service**. Veterans bring tremendous leadership, technical skill, and work ethic to our communities long after military retirement.

MARK SUPPORTS IMPROVING ACCESS TO

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Quality healthcare | ☐ Housing assistance |
| ☐ Mental health services | ☐ Workforce training & career transition |
| ☐ Addiction treatment | ☐ Jobs for veterans & military families |

“My oath did not end when I took off the uniform. Service is not simply a career — it is a lifelong responsibility.”

07

[ISSUE 08 / ANIMAL WELFARE]

Thirty years of caring for Oregon's animals.

As a veterinarian with over 30 years of experience serving communities around Portland, I have seen both the best and the worst of how animals are treated. This issue is deeply personal to me.

I strongly support responsible efforts to reduce animal cruelty, neglect, and pet overpopulation — through education, access to veterinary care, rescue support, and practical spay and neuter programs.

While **I do not support IP28**, I believe we have a moral responsibility to ensure animals are treated humanely and ethically. I will continue supporting practical, science-based approaches that improve animal welfare while respecting Oregon families, veterinarians, farmers, ranchers, hunters, and pet owners.

MARK SUPPORTS

- ☐ Humane education & owner support
- ☐ Access to affordable veterinary care
- ☐ Rescue & shelter support
- ☐ Practical spay & neuter programs
- ☐ Science-based welfare standards
- ☐ Respect for responsible animal ownership

“Compassion for animals and respect for responsible animal ownership can — and should — exist together.”

08

[ISSUE 09 / LOCAL ISSUES FIRST]

For the politically homeless.

Many people today feel politically homeless — uncomfortable with the extremism, division, and hostility entering our public discourse from multiple directions, and hesitant to speak openly about their beliefs for fear of being labeled.

Oregon must remain a place where people of different backgrounds, faiths, viewpoints, and political beliefs can live and work together respectfully. Antisemitism, anti-Christian hostility, racism, and hatred toward any group have no place in a healthy society.

At the same time, our state legislature should not be consumed by national ideological battles that distract from the real issues affecting Oregon families every single day. People do not need to agree on every national issue to work together to improve our communities. Most Oregonians want **balanced leadership, respectful dialogue, and common sense** — elected officials focused on solving problems rather than inflaming conflict.

THIS CAMPAIGN IS FOCUSED ON

- ☐ Affordability
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Public safety
- ☐ Small business growth
- ☐ Energy costs & transportation
- ☐ Housing & government accountability

“I welcome support from anyone — Republican, Democrat, independent, or unaffiliated — who believes Oregon can do better.”

[GET INVOLVED]

Practical leadership **for** **Oregon families.**

SERVICE • SOLUTIONS • ACCOUNTABILITY

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